



to prevent plants toppling under the weight of their fruits.

HARVESTING

Peppers change color as they ripen, from green to a range of colors. Harvest them when green and unripe, or leave them to ripen fully. Ripe fruits have a richer, sweeter flavor, but leaving them can reduce the overall yield.

STORING

Less fleshy forms of pepper, especially hot chili peppers, can be dried for long-term storage. Otherwise, use sweet peppers as soon as possible after picking.

PESTS AND DISEASES

Peppers can be attacked by sap-sucking insects such as capsid bugs or aphids, or by caterpillars. Biological controls are effective in greenhouses but insecticides might be required outdoors. Pick off any caterpillars that you find and apply an appropriate insecticide, if necessary. Few diseases affect peppers, but fungal rots might require control. To ensure healthy plants, practice good garden hygiene and ensure that plants are kept well ventilated, especially if you are growing them in a greenhouse.